

Digital Body Language Battlecard

Use visible cues to check understanding - never to diagnose a buyer's intent.

Critical guardrail: A single cue can have many causes: accessibility needs, camera placement, note-taking, fatigue, connection delay, distraction, or culture. Describe what you observe, then ask a neutral question.

THE TELL: what you observe	POSSIBLE meaning - not a fact	THE MOVE: neutral seller response
Eyes move away / typing begins	They may be taking notes, checking context, or multitasking.	Pause: "I may be moving quickly - what would be most useful to unpack here?"
Leans back / expression changes	The idea may feel unclear, risky, or simply new.	Check: "What reaction are you having to that approach?"
Unmutes / leans forward / raises hand	They may want to add, correct, or ask something.	Yield: stop talking and invite them in.
Looks toward someone off camera	Another person may be present or influencing the discussion.	Include: "Is anyone else weighing in who should be part of this?"
Long pause after a question	They may be thinking, uncertain, or waiting for someone else.	Hold two seconds, then: "Take your time - what part feels most important?"
Camera turns off / connection changes	Privacy, bandwidth, interruption, or discomfort may be involved.	Normalize: continue without pressure and confirm audio or meeting needs.

Question ladder: move from fact to implication without interrogation

Level	Example	Purpose
1. Context	"How many reps use this workflow today?"	Establish a factual baseline.
2. Process	"Can you walk me through what happens from lead assignment to first contact?"	Understand the current workflow.
3. Friction	"Where does that process slow down or create rework?"	Identify operational impact.
4. Implication	"When that delay repeats across the month, what does it affect downstream?"	Explore consequence in the buyer's words.

Practice: Record a five-minute role play. Mark one moment when you observed a cue, paused, and asked a neutral follow-up. Review whether you described the behavior without assigning motive.

External validation: Gong supports active listening, following the buyer's previous answer, and using video to make virtual conversation more human. Highspot supports flexible talk tracks and role-play practice. Sources: <https://www.gong.io/blog/best-discovery-call-tips> | <https://www.highspot.com/blog/sales-scripts/>

Next step: Ready to practice this live? Run the scenario in the VSM AI Role-Play Lab.